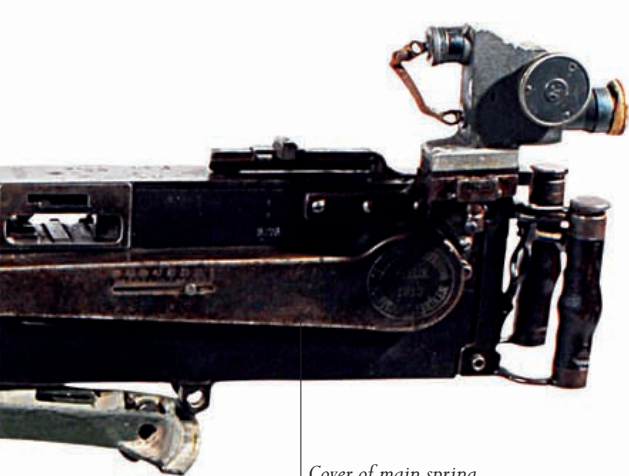




Cover of main spring, known as a "fusee"

► HOTCHKISS MODÈLE 1914

Date 1914

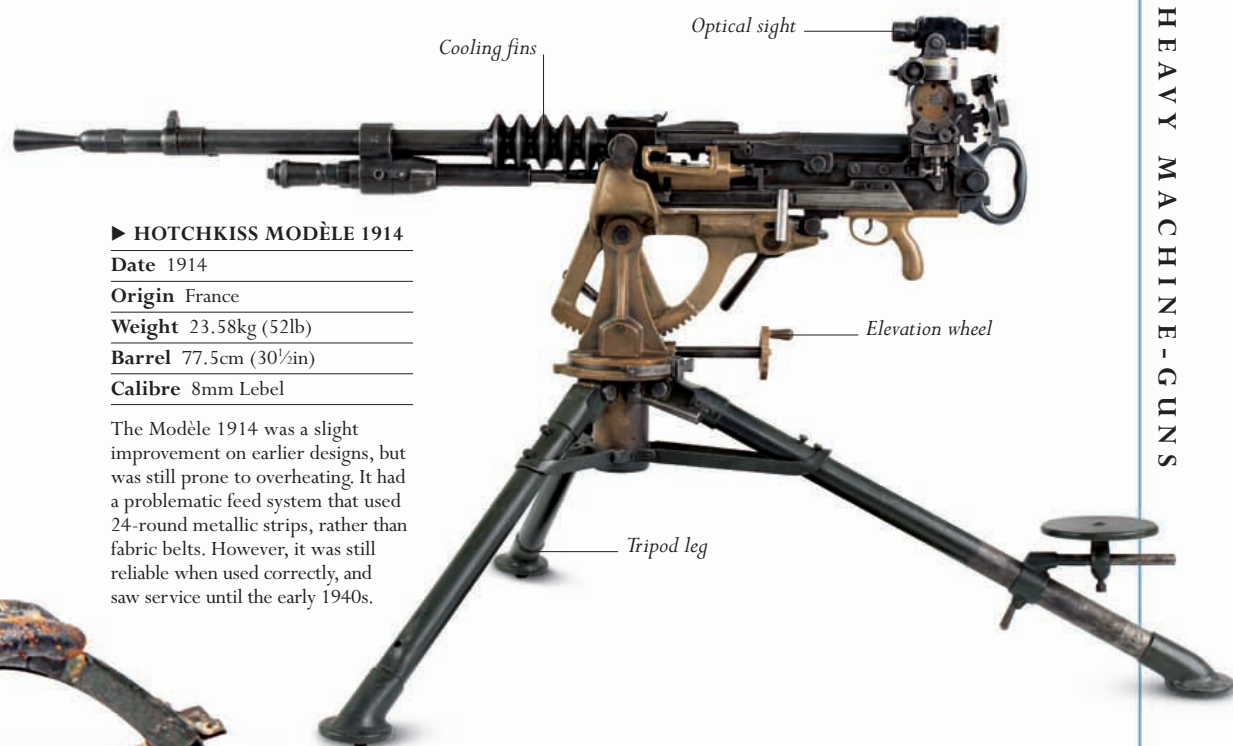
Origin France

Weight 23.58kg (52lb)

Barrel 77.5cm (30½in)

Calibre 8mm Lebel

The Modèle 1914 was a slight improvement on earlier designs, but was still prone to overheating. It had a problematic feed system that used 24-round metallic strips, rather than fabric belts. However, it was still reliable when used correctly, and saw service until the early 1940s.



Enlarged cap allowed water jacket to be filled with snow

▼ FIAT-REVELLI MODEL 1914

Date 1914

Origin Italy

Weight 17kg (37½lb)

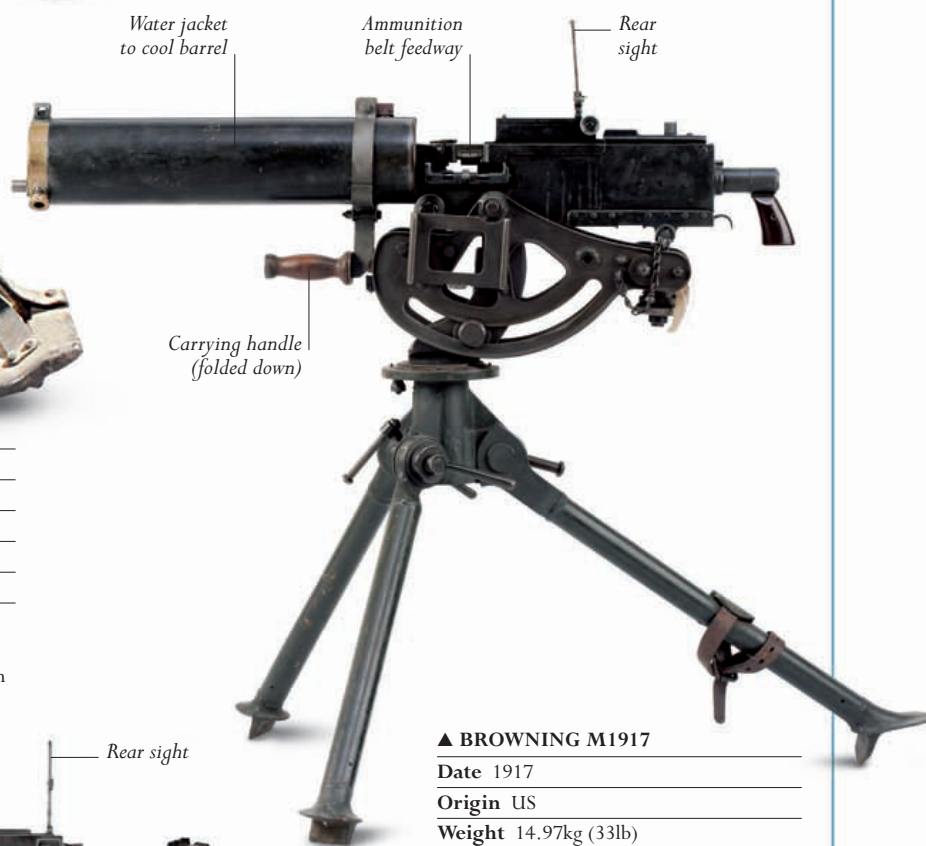
Barrel 65.4cm (25¾in)

Calibre 6.5mm Mannlicher-Carcano

This model employed a delayed "blowback" system to fire underpowered rounds, fed from a 50-round stack magazine and oiled on their way to the chamber. The oiled rounds picked up dust and dirt, causing the gun to jam regularly.



Flash hider



▲ BROWNING M1917

Date 1917

Origin US

Weight 14.97kg (33lb)

Barrel 61cm (24in)

Calibre .3in

John Browning produced a poor design of machine-gun for Colt, the gas-operated M1895 "Potato Digger" (see p.245), but later reverted to recoil actuation and improved on Maxim's method of locking barrel and breech together to create the M1917. It saw service in the latter months of World War I, but soon lost its water jacket to become the air-cooled M1919. It remained in use in that form until the 1960s.